Class 6 Social Science – Chapter 14: Economic Activities Around Us

NCERT | Exploring Society: India and Beyond | Economic Life Around Us

इस अध्याय के सभी मुख्य विषयों को सरल अंग्रेजी में समझाया गया है। इसमें पाठ के प्रश्नों, Think About It, Let's Explore और Questions, Activities and Projects के उत्तरों के साथ-साथ परीक्षा के लिए महत्वपूर्ण संभावित प्रश्न-उत्तर, परिभाषाएँ, MCQs और रिवीजन नोट्स शामिल हैं।

Part 1: The Big Questions (Page 195)

Q1. How are economic activities classified?

Answer: Economic activities are classified into three main sectors: primary, secondary, and tertiary sectors.

- Primary sector: It obtains goods or raw materials directly from nature.
- Secondary sector: It changes raw materials into finished goods.
- Tertiary sector: It provides services that support the primary and secondary sectors.

Q2. What differentiates these activities to be grouped into sectors?

Answer: Economic activities are grouped according to the nature of the work they involve. Activities that obtain resources from nature belong to the primary sector. Activities that process raw materials belong to the secondary sector. Activities that provide services belong to the tertiary sector.

Q3. How are the three sectors interconnected?

Answer: The three sectors depend on one another. The primary sector provides raw materials, the secondary sector uses them to make finished goods, and the tertiary sector provides services such as transport, banking, and trade. Together, they help produce and deliver goods to consumers.

Part 2: Textbook Activities and Their Answers

A. Think About It — Primary Activities (Page 199)

Q. Can you think of any primary activities that you may have seen? What natural resources are used in these activities? Name two and discuss your experiences.

Answer:

1. Farming: Farmers use soil, water, sunlight, and seeds to grow crops.
2. Fishing: Fishers use rivers, ponds, lakes, or seas to catch fish.

Both activities depend directly on natural resources.

B. Let's Explore — Secondary Activities (Page 200)

Q. Name two more economic activities in the secondary sector.

Answer:

1. Making paper from wood pulp.
2. Making sugar from sugarcane.

Both activities process raw materials to produce useful goods.

C. Dairy Cooperative: From Farm to Plate (Pages 202–205)

Q1. What problems did dairy farmers face before forming a cooperative?

Answer: Farmers had to carry milk to nearby villages and sell it quickly because milk spoiled in hot weather. Middlemen bought milk at low prices and sold it in the market. Farmers often felt cheated and earned little money.

Q2. What is a cooperative?

Answer: A cooperative is a group of people who voluntarily come together to meet their economic and social needs. Members make decisions collectively and work for their common benefit.

Q3. Who advised the farmers to form a cooperative?

Answer: Sardar Vallabhbhai Patel advised the farmers to form a cooperative so that they could work together and reduce their dependence on middlemen.

Q4. When was AMUL set up, and who led its establishment?

Answer: AMUL was set up in 1946 under the leadership of Tribhuvandas Patel and Dr. Verghese Kurien.

Q5. How did the cooperative help the farmers?

Answer: The cooperative helped farmers collect, process, and sell milk together. They gained greater control over production and sales, made collective decisions, reduced their dependence on middlemen, and gradually increased their income.

Q6. Name some products made from milk by dairy cooperatives.

Answer: Milk powder, butter, ghee, and cheese are some products made from milk.

Q7. Which economic sectors are involved in the AMUL example?

Answer:

- Primary sector: Farmers obtain milk from cows and buffaloes.
- Secondary sector: Factories process milk to make butter, ghee, cheese, and milk powder.
- Tertiary sector: Transport, trade, and retail services deliver and sell the products to consumers.

D. Think About It — Making Books (Page 207)

Q. Observe Figure 14.1 on page 206 and discuss the different stages of making books.

Answer: Books are made through several stages:

1. Trees are cut to obtain wood.
2. The wood is transported to a processing unit.
3. Wood is processed to obtain pulp.
4. Pulp is converted into paper.
5. Paper is transported to a printing unit.
6. Textbooks are printed on the paper.
7. Finished books are transported to shops.
8. Shops sell the books to students and other customers.

The diagram on page 206 shows how raw materials are changed into finished books with the help of all three economic sectors.

E. Let's Explore — Label the Stages of Making Books (Pages 206–207)

Q. Label the pictures in Figure 14.1 as primary, secondary, or tertiary sector activities.

Answer:

Stage	Sector	Reason
Cutting trees to obtain wood	Primary	Wood is obtained directly from nature.
Processing wood into pulp	Secondary	Raw material is processed.
Transporting wood or pulp	Tertiary	Transport is a service.
Making paper from pulp	Secondary	Pulp is converted into paper.
Transporting paper to the printing unit	Tertiary	Transport is a service.
Printing textbooks	Secondary	Paper is converted into finished books.

Selling books in shops	Tertiary	Retail is a service.

F. Let's Explore — Saving Paper (Page 207)

Q. What are the different ways through which we can judiciously use paper in our school classrooms and offices?

Answer:

1. Write on both sides of a sheet of paper.
2. Avoid tearing or wasting pages.
3. Reuse one-sided sheets for rough work.
4. Recycle used paper.
5. Use digital documents when suitable.
6. Share notices digitally instead of printing many copies.

The chapter states that recycling one tonne of paper saves 17 trees and uses 70% less energy and water than making new paper from wood pulp.

G. Let's Explore — Economic Activities in Your Neighbourhood (Page 208)

Q1. List economic activities in your neighbourhood and classify them into the three sectors.

Answer:

Economic activity	Sector
Farming	Primary
Fishing	Primary
Dairy farming	Primary
Making bricks	Secondary
Making furniture	Secondary
Manufacturing clothes	Secondary
Teaching in a school	Tertiary
Driving a bus	Tertiary
Banking	Tertiary
Selling goods in a shop	Tertiary

Q2. How are these activities connected to each other?

Answer: Farmers grow cotton, factories use cotton to make clothes, and transporters and shopkeepers help deliver and sell the clothes to customers. Each activity depends on the others.

Q3. What would happen if one of these activities ceased to exist?

Answer: Other activities could face problems. For example, if transport stopped, raw materials might not reach factories and finished goods might not reach shops. This could affect production, trade, and people's livelihoods.

Part 3: End-of-Chapter Questions (Page 208)

Q1. What is the primary sector? How is it different from the secondary sector? Give two examples.

Answer: The primary sector includes activities in which people obtain goods or raw materials directly from nature. The secondary sector includes activities in which raw materials are processed to make finished goods.

Examples:

- Primary sector: Farming and fishing.
- Secondary sector: Making paper from wood pulp and making clothes from cotton.

Q2. How does the secondary sector depend on the tertiary sector? Illustrate with a few examples.

Answer: The secondary sector depends on the tertiary sector for transport, communication, banking, and trade.

For example:

1. Factories need transport services to bring raw materials.
2. Manufacturers use banking services to make payments.
3. Trucks and trains carry finished goods to markets.
4. Shops sell manufactured goods to consumers.

Without these services, factories would find it difficult to produce and sell goods efficiently.

Q3. Give an example of interdependence between the primary, secondary, and tertiary sectors. Show it using a flow diagram.

Answer: The production and sale of cotton clothes is an example.

Primary Sector

Farmers grow cotton.

Secondary Sector

Factories turn cotton into cloth and clothes.

Tertiary Sector

Transporters and shopkeepers deliver and sell the clothes.

Consumers buy and use the clothes.

Conclusion: All three sectors depend on one another. The primary sector supplies raw materials, the secondary sector manufactures goods, and the tertiary sector helps transport and sell them.

Part 4: Important Questions and Answers from Every Topic

Topic 1: Classification of Economic Activities

Q1. What is monetary value?

Answer: Monetary value is the value of something that can be measured in terms of money.

Q2. What are economic sectors?

Answer: Economic sectors are broad groups of economic activities that have similar characteristics.

Q3. Name the three main economic sectors.

Answer: The three main economic sectors are the primary sector, the secondary sector, and the tertiary sector.

Q4. Why do we classify economic activities into sectors?

Answer: We classify economic activities into sectors to understand the nature of different activities and how they are connected to one another.

Q5. How have economic activities changed over time?

Answer: In the past, many people were involved in farming, livestock rearing, pottery, weaving, and making tools. Today, people also work in computer manufacturing, software development, banking, hotels, and many other fields.

Topic 2: Primary Sector

Q1. What is the primary sector?

Answer: The primary sector includes activities in which people depend directly on nature to obtain raw materials or produce goods.

Q2. Name five activities of the primary sector.

Answer: Agriculture, mining, fishing, raising livestock, and forestry.

Q3. Why is agriculture a primary activity?

Answer: Agriculture is a primary activity because farmers depend directly on natural resources such as soil, water, sunlight, and seeds to grow crops.

Q4. Why is mining included in the primary sector?

Answer: Mining is included in the primary sector because minerals and other resources are extracted directly from the earth.

Q5. Why is fishing a primary activity?

Answer: Fishing is a primary activity because fish are obtained directly from natural or farmed water resources.

Q6. What natural resources are used in primary activities?

Answer: Primary activities use resources such as land, soil, water, forests, minerals, sunlight, and animals.

Q7. Give examples of products obtained from the primary sector.

Answer: Grains, vegetables, milk, eggs, fish, timber, coal, and minerals.

Topic 3: Secondary Sector

Q1. What is the secondary sector?

Answer: The secondary sector includes activities in which raw materials obtained from nature are processed or transformed into products for sale or use.

Q2. Name five activities of the secondary sector.

Answer: Manufacturing clothes, making furniture, constructing buildings, producing electricity, and making paper.

Q3. Why is manufacturing called a secondary activity?

Answer: Manufacturing is called a secondary activity because it transforms raw materials into finished or more useful products.

Q4. How is cotton converted into clothes?

Answer: Cotton is obtained from cotton plants. It is processed into yarn, woven into cloth, and then stitched into clothes.

Q5. How is wood converted into furniture?

Answer: Wood obtained from trees is cut, shaped, and joined by carpenters or workers to make furniture.

Q6. How is wheat converted into flour?

Answer: Wheat grains obtained from farms are taken to a mill, where they are ground into flour.

Q7. Why are construction and electricity production included in the secondary sector in this chapter?

Answer: The chapter groups construction and electricity production under the secondary sector because they involve building structures or producing useful outputs needed by people and other economic activities.

Topic 4: Tertiary Sector

Q1. What is the tertiary sector?

Answer: The tertiary sector includes activities that provide services and support the primary and secondary sectors. It is also called the service sector.

Q2. Name six activities of the tertiary sector.

Answer: Transportation, banking, healthcare, education, communication, and trade.

Q3. Why is transportation a tertiary activity?

Answer: Transportation is a tertiary activity because it provides a service by moving people and goods from one place to another.

Q4. Why are teachers and doctors included in the tertiary sector?

Answer: Teachers provide education services, while doctors provide healthcare services.

Q5. What role do banks play in economic activities?

Answer: Banks provide services such as keeping money safe, making payments, and providing loans to people and businesses.

Q6. Why are shopkeepers included in the tertiary sector?

Answer: Shopkeepers sell goods to consumers and help connect producers with buyers.

Q7. Why is the tertiary sector also called the service sector?

Answer: It is called the service sector because its main activities involve providing services rather than directly extracting raw materials or manufacturing goods.

Topic 5: Interdependence Among the Three Sectors

Q1. What is interdependence among economic sectors?

Answer: Interdependence means that different sectors depend on one another to carry out their activities successfully.

Q2. How does the primary sector support the secondary sector?

Answer: The primary sector supplies raw materials such as cotton, wood, milk, grains, and minerals to the secondary sector.

Q3. How does the tertiary sector support the primary sector?

Answer: The tertiary sector supports farmers and other primary producers through transport, banking, communication, storage, and trade services.

Q4. How does the tertiary sector support the secondary sector?

Answer: It transports raw materials to factories, helps businesses make payments, and carries finished products to shops and consumers.

Q5. Can the three sectors work completely independently? Explain.

Answer: Generally, no. The sectors depend on one another for raw materials, processing, transport, and sales. A problem in one sector can affect activities in the other sectors.

Q6. Give an example of interdependence involving milk.

Answer: Farmers produce milk in the primary sector. Factories process milk into butter, ghee, and cheese in the secondary sector. Transporters, traders, and retailers help deliver and sell these products in the tertiary sector.

Topic 6: AMUL and Dairy Cooperatives

Q1. What is AMUL?

Answer: AMUL is a dairy cooperative that collects milk from farmers, processes it into different products, and helps sell those products.

Q2. Why did farmers form a milk cooperative?

Answer: Farmers formed a cooperative to work together, improve their earnings, control milk collection and sales, and reduce dependence on middlemen.

Q3. Who were Tribhuvandas Patel and Dr. Verghese Kurien?

Answer: Tribhuvandas Patel was a lawyer and freedom fighter who helped lead the establishment of AMUL. Dr. Verghese Kurien was an engineer who played an important role in developing the dairy cooperative movement.

Q4. What is a middleman?

Answer: A middleman is a person who buys goods from producers and sells them to consumers or other buyers.

Q5. What is pasteurisation?

Answer: Pasteurisation is a process in which milk is heated to a specific temperature to kill harmful bacteria and help preserve it.

Q6. How does AMUL use all three economic sectors?

Answer: Farmers obtain milk, factories process it into dairy products, and transporters, traders, and retailers help distribute and sell those products.

Q7. Name other milk cooperatives mentioned in the chapter.

Answer: Nandini, Mother Dairy, Aavin, Vijaya, Kevi, Sudha, and Verka.

Q8. How does a cooperative benefit its members?

Answer: A cooperative allows members to work together, make collective decisions, share responsibilities, and work towards common economic and social goals.

Topic 7: Making Paper and Books

Q1. What is the first raw material used in the book-making process shown in the chapter?

Answer: Wood from trees is used to obtain pulp, which is then processed into paper.

Q2. How are books produced from wood?

Answer: Wood is processed into pulp, pulp is made into paper, and the paper is printed to produce books. The books are then transported and sold.

Q3. Which sector is involved in making paper?

Answer: The secondary sector is involved in making paper because it transforms wood pulp into paper.

Q4. Which sector is involved in selling books?

Answer: The tertiary sector is involved in selling books because retailing is a service.

Q5. Why is recycling paper important?

Answer: Recycling paper helps save trees, reduces the amount of waste sent to landfills, and uses less energy and water than making new paper from wood pulp.

Q6. How are all three sectors involved in making books?

Answer: The primary sector supplies wood. The secondary sector processes wood into pulp and paper and prints books. The tertiary sector provides transport and retail services.

Topic 8: Economic Activities in Our Neighbourhood

Q1. Give examples of primary activities in a village.

Answer: Farming, fishing, dairy farming, livestock rearing, and forestry.

Q2. Give examples of secondary activities in a town or city.

Answer: Making clothes, producing bricks, manufacturing furniture, processing food, and constructing buildings.

Q3. Give examples of tertiary activities in a town or city.

Answer: Teaching, banking, transportation, healthcare, selling goods, and repairing vehicles.

Q4. What may happen if factories stop receiving raw materials?

Answer: Factories may not be able to continue production. Workers may lose work, and shops may receive fewer finished goods.

Q5. What may happen if transport services stop?

Answer: Raw materials and finished goods may not reach their destinations on time. This can affect factories, markets, and consumers.

Part 5: Important Definitions

Term	Meaning in simple English
Economic activity	An activity that creates monetary value.
Monetary value	The value of something measured in money.
Economic sector	A broad group of similar economic activities.
Primary sector	Activities that obtain goods or raw materials directly from nature.
Secondary sector	Activities that process raw materials into products.
Tertiary sector	Activities that provide services to people and businesses.
Raw material	A basic material used to make a product.
Manufacturing	The process of making products from raw materials.
Cooperative	A group of people who work together for common needs and benefits.
Middleman	A person who buys goods from producers and sells them to others.
Dairy	A place where milk is collected and stored.
Pasteurisation	Heating milk to a specific temperature to kill harmful bacteria.
Factory	A place where goods are manufactured or assembled.
Retail	Selling goods in small quantities to the final consumer.
Export	Selling goods or services produced in one country to another country.
Warehouse	A large building used for storing goods.
Interdependence	A situation in which different people or activities depend on one another.

Part 6: Multiple-Choice Questions (MCQs)

Test Your Knowledge

0/20 answered

1. How many main economic sectors are discussed in this chapter?

A. Two
B. Three
C. Four
D. Five

2. Which sector includes farming?

A. Primary
B. Secondary
C. Tertiary
D. None

3. Which sector includes manufacturing clothes?

A. Primary
B. Secondary
C. Tertiary
D. None

4. Which sector includes banking?

A. Primary
B. Secondary
C. Tertiary
D. None

5. Which is a primary activity?

A. Teaching
B. Mining
C. Banking
D. Retailing

6. Which is a secondary activity?

A. Fishing
B. Forestry
C. Making furniture
D. Selling books

7. Which is a tertiary activity?

A. Growing wheat
B. Extracting coal
C. Making paper
D. Transportation

8. What does the primary sector supply to factories?

A. Only services
B. Raw materials
C. Only finished goods
D. Bank accounts

9. What is the tertiary sector also called?

A. Farming sector
B. Service sector
C. Mining sector
D. Factory sector

10. When was AMUL set up according to the chapter?

A. 1930
B. 1946
C. 1956
D. 1965

11. Who advised farmers to form a cooperative?

A. Dr. Verghese Kurien
B. Sardar Vallabhbhai Patel
C. Rajendra Prasad
D. Mahatma Gandhi

12. What is a cooperative?

A. A group working for common needs
B. A type of factory only
C. A government tax
D. A transport vehicle

13. Which is a product made from milk?

A. Coal
B. Paper
C. Butter
D. Cotton

14. What is pasteurisation used for?

A. Making clothes
B. Killing harmful bacteria in milk
C. Growing crops
D. Transporting goods

15. Which sector sells books in shops?

A. Primary
B. Secondary

C. Tertiary
D. Agricultural

16. What is a middleman?

A. A person who buys from producers and resells goods
B. A farmer who grows crops
C. A person who manufactures paper only
D. A schoolteacher

17. What is one benefit of recycling paper?

A. It increases waste
B. It saves trees
C. It wastes more water
D. It stops all transport

18. Which sector turns cotton into cloth?

A. Primary
B. Secondary
C. Tertiary
D. None

19. Which service helps carry goods to markets?

A. Mining
B. Forestry
C. Transportation
D. Farming

20. What does interdependence mean?

A. Working without any help
B. Depending on one another
C. Stopping all production
D. Selling only raw materials
Check Answers

Part 7: True or False

No.	Statement	Answer
1	Economic activities are divided into three main sectors in this chapter.	True
2	Farming belongs to the tertiary sector.	False

3	Mining is a primary activity.	True
4	Manufacturing converts raw materials into products.	True
5	Banking is a primary activity.	False
6	The tertiary sector is also called the service sector.	True
7	Factories do not need raw materials.	False
8	AMUL is a dairy cooperative.	True
9	Middlemen buy goods from producers and sell them to others.	True
10	Pasteurisation helps kill harmful bacteria in milk.	True
11	Transport is an example of a tertiary activity.	True
12	The three economic sectors are completely independent.	False
13	Making paper from pulp is a secondary activity.	True
14	Retail means selling goods to final consumers.	True
15	Recycling paper can help save trees.	True

Part 8: Quick Revision Notes

- Economic activities create monetary value.
- The three economic sectors are primary, secondary, and tertiary.
- The primary sector obtains raw materials directly from nature.
- The secondary sector processes raw materials into useful products.
- The tertiary sector provides services such as banking, transport, education, healthcare, and trade.
- All three sectors depend on one another.
- AMUL is an example of a dairy cooperative that connects all three sectors.
- In book production, wood is obtained from trees, processed into paper, printed into books, and then transported and sold.
- Cooperatives help people work together and pursue common economic goals.
- Recycling paper saves resources and reduces waste.

Most Important Questions for Examination

1. Define the primary, secondary, and tertiary sectors with examples.
2. Explain the difference between the primary and secondary sectors.
3. How does the tertiary sector support the secondary sector?
4. Explain the interdependence of the three economic sectors with a flow diagram.
5. Describe the role of AMUL in improving the lives of dairy farmers.
6. What is a cooperative? How does it help its members?
7. Explain how books are made and identify the three sectors involved.
8. What is pasteurisation?
9. What is the role of middlemen in the sale of goods?
10. Why is recycling paper important?

These notes cover the chapter's main text, diagrams, activities, and end-of-chapter questions in simple English for Class 6 revision.